

Connected to the world. Is every store and pump connected to you?

Read from your own public record — not inside knowledge. Dutoit makes its margin in the orchard, in the packhouse and in months of CA storage across five regions. In May 2026 the region's cold chain ran on generators for weeks — which is when **seeing every room, pump and generator from Ceres** matters most.

~5,000 ha

UNDER IRRIGATION · KOUE & WARM BOKKEVELD, WITZENBERG, SANDVELD, WORCESTER, LANGKLOOF

Source: dutoit.com/about, seen 2 Oct 2026

26,500

BULK-BIN CA STORAGE AT NOVO, PAARL (JOINED DEC 2024), PLUS THREE CERES PACKHOUSES

Source: dutoit.com/packing-facilities, seen 2 Oct 2026

8,000+

PEOPLE AT PEAK HARVEST

Source: dutoitagri.co.za/about/our-people, seen 2 Oct 2026

What we see in **your operation**

WHERE	WHAT HAPPENS TODAY	WHAT IT COSTS
CA and cold stores	Pylons fell at Waaihoek on 10–12 May; regional supply dropped to 15–20% for weeks. Over 300,000 t of export fruit sat in cold storage on generators.	Industry: ~R2m diesel a day for ~50 days. Dutoit's own exposure: to confirm
Orchards	2026 hail and wind hit Ceres and the Langkloof; sunburn from hour-long heat spikes is the Bokkeveld's biggest challenge.	Ceres crop estimate cut 5–15% (industry). Dutoit share: to confirm
Pumps and dams	Spread across mountain valleys in several regions; May floods took out pumps, roads and dams in the lower areas.	Travel to check, late fault discovery, water data for UK buyers: to confirm
Farms to packhouse	ViTrax bin and pallet tracking and cloud ERP depend on links from every farm and store.	Throughput and reporting when a link drops in season: to confirm

Sources: FreshFruitPortal 19 May 2026; IOL 19 May 2026; Food For Mzansi; Daily Maverick 27 May 2026; FreshPlaza (Langkloof and Ceres estimates); FarSoft. Industry figures are regional, not Dutoit's.

When the grid fails at harvest, you need fruit that still makes its programme, and you need to know that from Ceres without sending a bakkie to every store.

Your own **private backbone**, alongside the links you have

You have already brought proper connectivity to your farms and packhouses. We would add what sits inside: a Dutoit-owned network across each production cluster, starting with the Koue Bokkeveld farms, Ceres head office, packhouses and cold stores. It runs on its own solar-and-battery relay sites, so it does not depend on the grid. One backbone carries **pumps, sensors, cold-room alarms, cameras and voice**, and CTTX supports it under SLA.

Every store visible from Ceres

Room temperature, O2/CO2, compressor and generator status reach your team on a network that keeps running through an outage.

Pumps and dams without the drive

Live status, flow and dam levels across the valleys. Measured water data for buyer stewardship reporting, not estimates.

Block-level climate data

Weather stations and sensors in the orchards, live, for hour-scale heat and hail decisions.

Owned, not rented

The backbone is Dutoit's asset and fits a standardise-simplify-automate ICT strategy. Optional second carrier path into Ceres for resilience. Supported by CTTX under SLA.

Proof that fits: Sandy Mountain, 33,000 ha, off-grid

We moved the reserve from a 3/8 Mbps consumer service to 100 Mbps symmetrical carrier backhaul and an 800+ Mbps private backbone. Off-grid solar relays report their own battery state. Call-outs went to zero.

One honest point: we have not seen inside your network, and you may already have parts of this in place. The first conversation is to find out where it reaches and where it doesn't.

Next step

- 1 A 20-minute conversation:** you, Willem Coetzee if useful, and me. We'd cover what happened in May and what runs on-farm today.
- 2 A desktop terrain and line-of-sight review** of your Koue Bokkeveld sites. That is the first step in designing your own network, and no site visit is needed.

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